

Melanocetus johnsonii

Humpback anglerfish



Location Pacific, Atlantic, Indian Ocean

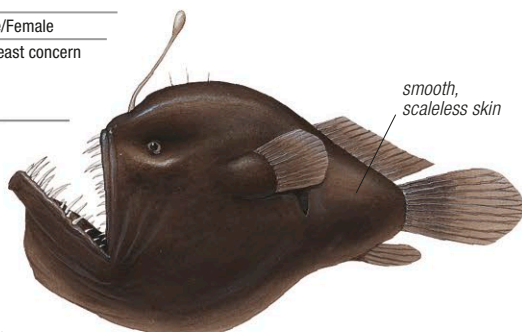
Length Female up to 7 in (18 cm)

Weight Up to 21 oz (600 g)

Sex Male/Female

Status Least concern

dorsal fin. The male has no lure, and is less than one-fifth as long as his mate. He attaches himself to the female with his jaws but, unlike other deep-sea anglers, swims away after she has spawned.



This deep-sea anglerfish hunts in open water rather than on the seabed. The female is rounded, with an enormous head and jaws, and a lure on her

Diodon holocanthus

Longspined porcupinefish



Location Tropical and subtropical waters worldwide

Length Up to 20 in (50 cm)

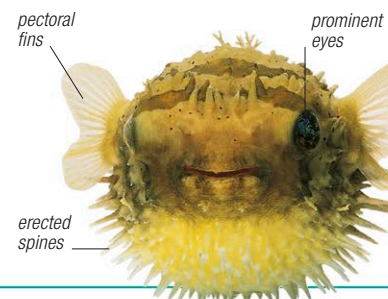
Weight Not recorded

Sex Male/Female

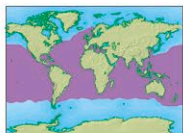
Status Least concern

If threatened, this spine-covered fish swallows large amounts of water, inflating itself until it becomes almost spherical, and making its spines,

which are usually folded back, stand on end. But the spiny armor may hinder its ability to swim, and it is often found entangled in nets, much to the annoyance of fishermen. Brown above and yellow below, longspined porcupinefishes are reef dwellers. Their powerful jaws, armed with fused teeth, enable them to crack the shells and skeletons of many marine invertebrates.

*Mola mola*

Oceanic sunfish



Location Tropical, subtropical, and temperate waters worldwide

Length Up to 13 ft (4 m)

Weight Up to 2 1/4 tons (2 tonnes)

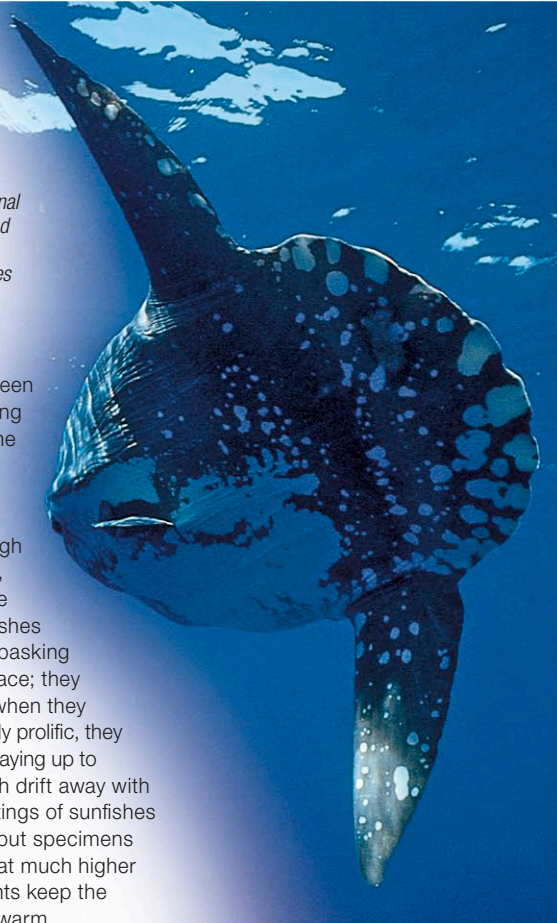
Sex Male/Female

Status Vulnerable

ERECT FINS

The triangular dorsal and anal fins are placed far back, and are held erect like a pair of giant blades. This fish moves by sculling with these fins.

almost circular when seen from the side. The young are elliptical in shape. The oceanic sunfish feeds primarily on jellyfish, using its teeth to nip pieces off prey. Although generally slow-moving, it may jump clear of the water if alarmed. Sunfishes are occasionally seen basking horizontally at the surface; they probably do this only when they are sick or dying. Hugely prolific, they breed in the open sea, laying up to 300 million eggs, which drift away with the current. Most sightings of sunfishes are in tropical waters, but specimens are occasionally seen at much higher latitudes, where currents keep the temperature relatively warm.

*Balistoides conspicillum*

Clown triggerfish



Location Pacific, Indian Ocean

Length Up to 20 in (50 cm)

Weight Up to 4 1/2 lb (2 kg)

Sex Male/Female

Status Not evaluated

This exceptionally colorful, coral-reef species belongs to a family of fishes that can lock their 3 dorsal spines upright, enabling them to wedge themselves into crevices. Its head is covered with tough, protective scales, and its teeth are strong and adapted to crushing the shells of prey such as mollusks and crustaceans. Like other triggerfishes, it can be very territorial, especially during the mating season.



DISK SHAPE

Seen in profile, this fish resembles a huge disk. Its mouth has a padded upper lip, and it has small eyes on either side. The tail is little more than a narrow frill attached directly to the body.

*Takifugu niphobles*

Fugu



Location W. North Pacific

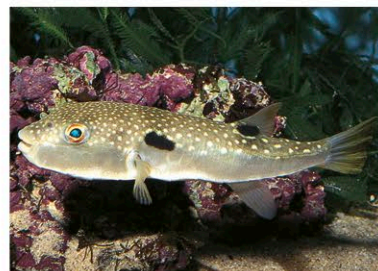
Length Up to 6 in (15 cm)

Weight Not recorded

Sex Male/Female

Status Data deficient

may inflate its body—by pumping water into an inflatable sac in the stomach—and erect the spines on its sides. The fugu breeds between May and July, 1–5 days after the full and new moons. Thousands of these fishes arrive to spawn on pebbly beaches at high tide.



Despite the fact that the fugu contains a poison more potent than cyanide, it is considered a great delicacy in Japan, where it and similar fish are prepared. To deter predators, this fish may secrete its powerful neurotoxin into the water, or it

Lactoria cornuta

Longhorn cowfish



Location Pacific, Indian Ocean, Red Sea

Length Up to 18 in (46 cm)

Weight Not recorded

Sex Male/Female

Status Not evaluated

The longhorn cowfish derives its name from the small, hornlike projections above each eye. A rigid boxlike casing of bony

plates under the skin make it a clumsy swimmer and account for its other name, the boxfish. This fish hunts by blowing jets of water into the sand on the ocean floor to expose the bottom-living invertebrates on which it feeds. Longhorn cowfishes are caught and dried to sell as ornaments.

